

Utkarsh Barethiya

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github.com/Utkarsh-Barethiya | crackthehack.in (Portfolio) | Stamp 1G Holder

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Consultant with 2.5+ years of hands-on experience conducting offensive security engagements, Active Directory exploitation, and web application assessments for enterprise banking environments. Holds a First Class Honours MSc in Cybersecurity and CEHv11, eJPT and CRTP certificates. Proven ability to bridge offensive security findings with Secure SDLC engineering, CI/CD security automation, and threat modeling.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security: Penetration Testing (VAPT), Active Directory Exploitation, Privilege Escalation, Lateral Movement, Kerberoasting, Adversary Simulation, Red Teaming, Purple Teaming.

Software & Application Security: Web/REST API Security, OWASP Top 10, Secure Code Review, Secure SDLC, Design-Stage Threat Modeling, SAST/DAST/SCA Integration.

Programming & Automation: Python, Bash, JavaScript/TypeScript (Next.js, NestJS), SQL (PostgreSQL), Docker, Git, CI/CD (GitHub Actions).

SIEM & Incident Detection: Splunk Enterprise, Windows Event Logging (Event IDs 4624, 4672, 4688), SIEM Rule Creation, MITRE ATT&CK Mapping.

Tools & Frameworks: Burp Suite Pro, Metasploit, Nmap, Nessus Pro, Mimikatz, BloodHound, SharpHound, Wireshark, SQLMap, Postman, CVSS, NIST CSF.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Anzen Technologies Pvt Ltd. – India, Navi Mumbai

Associate Security Consultant

Aug 2022 - Jan 2024

Security Consultant

Feb 2024 - Dec 2024

Key Client Engagements: Leading Stock Exchange | Leading Banking Organisation

- Reduced the attack surface across 1,000+ enterprise endpoints for a major banking client by identifying Kerberoasting vectors, privilege escalation points and lateral movement opportunities prioritized for remediation based on CVSS v3 scores and impact analysis.
- Provided remediation recommendations for critical business logic and authentication flaws discovered across the enterprise's core web applications, REST APIs and thick/thin clients during manual payload testing, protocol level analysis and SAST/DAST evaluations focused on OWASP Top 10.
- Enhanced SOC detection capabilities and alert triage accuracy by contributing to Purple Team exercises and real world cyber defence simulations across Splunk, Forcepoint, Cisco Firewalls, EDR platforms and Palo Alto networks.
- Driven Secure SDLC initiatives within the organization by conducting design-stage threat modeling, code reviews for proposed bug fixes and secure coding guidelines for development teams during various stages of the software development lifecycle.
- Expanded security testing expertise to include iOS/Android mobile apps and ATM interface hardware using a combination of black-box, grey-box and white-box testing methodologies.
- Led security assessments to CERT-In prescribed national testing standards, producing reports for CERT-In empanelled engagements.

KEY PROJECTS & OPEN SOURCE (GitHub)

ForgeAI – AI Security Learning Platform | Creator & Lead Developer (In Progress)

- Designing and developing an open-source AI Security Learning Platform using Next.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL and Docker to deepen my understanding of AI Security and secure software development while encouraging the security community to learn, contribute and grow together through intentionally vulnerable and secure application implementations.
- Implemented enterprise-grade security controls including JWT authentication with refresh token rotation, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), and API rate limiting.
- In Established automated DevSecOps pipelines through GitHub Actions, implementing SAST, SCA, and container dependency scanning to enforce Secure-by-Design principles.

BUG BOUNTY & RESPONSIBLE DISCLOSURE:

- Identified and responsibly disclosed vulnerabilities in production systems of organisations including Dell, Swiggy, BigBasket & others and received multiple Hall of Fame recognitions for responsible disclosure contributions.

EDUCATION

MSc in Cybersecurity (First Class Honours)
Dublin Business School

04/2025 - 06/2026
Dublin, Ireland

Dissertation: Enterprise Active Directory Attack Simulation: Evaluating Phishing Initiated Active Directory Compromise Paths in SMEs: A Simulation Based Red and Blue Team Risk Assessment Framework

- Built a virtual enterprise AD lab with Windows server, clients, and Kali Linux, which emulates the attack chain for phishing, enumeration, credential harvesting, and lateral movement.
- Deployed Splunk enterprise with universal forwarders to collect Windows security logs and built searching queries to detect anomalous events and possible privilege elevation attempts (Event IDs 4624, 4672, 4688).
- Developed an enterprise-level risk assessment framework for red/blue teaming that utilizes ATT&CK® mitigation framework and maps attack procedures to the corresponding SIEM event detection capabilities.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Red Team Operator (CRTO) - Zero-Point Security | In Progress
- Certified Red Team Professional (CRTP) - Altered Security
- Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT) - eLearnSecurity
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH v11) - EC-Council